

Caleb H. Kelley, Ph.D.

Visiting Assistant Professor
Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University

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📍 Atlanta, GA

Last updated: September 2025

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Romance Languages

The University of Alabama

August 2017 – August 2024

Tuscaloosa, AL

- **Dissertation:** *Sounding gay and straight in Seville: A variationist perspective on persona and syllable-final /s/ realization*
- **Advisor:** Dr. Erin O'Rourke

M.A. in Romance Languages

The University of Alabama

August 2015 – May 2017

Tuscaloosa, AL

B.A. in Spanish

University of Alabama at Birmingham

August 2010 – December 2013

Birmingham, AL

B.S. in Biology

University of Alabama at Birmingham

August 2010 – December 2013

Birmingham, AL

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research explores the intersection of language, identity, and social meaning, focusing on how speakers use phonetic variation to construct and negotiate social identities in Spanish-speaking communities. Grounded in sociophonetics and third-wave sociolinguistics, I employ performance-based methodologies that foreground social personae to examine how linguistic choices both reflect and shape identity. My work engages with questions of gender, sexuality, and representation, offering insights into language's role in fostering critical awareness, cultural competence, and inclusive leadership. In teaching, I integrate these perspectives with second language acquisition and culturally responsive pedagogy to create learning environments that empower students to be effective communicators in a global context.

Areas of specialization: Hispanic linguistics; phonetics and phonology; sociolinguistics; language variation and change; dialectology; quantitative/experimental methodology; language, gender, and sexuality; second language acquisition; marginalized dialects; language attitudes and ideologies; educational technology

EMPLOYMENT

Visiting Assistant Professor <i>Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University</i>	2024 – present Atlanta, GA
Graduate Teaching Assistant/Instructor of Record <i>Department of Modern Languages and Classics, The University of Alabama</i>	2015 – 2024 Tuscaloosa, AL
Adjunct Instructor of Spanish <i>Department of English and World Languages, University of Montevallo</i>	2021 – 2022 Montevallo, AL

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscripts in Preparation

- Kelley, C. H.** (in preparation). Prosodic identity performance in Sevillian Spanish: A mixed-effects analysis of gay and straight vocal personae [Revising for submission to the *Journal of Language and Sexuality*]
- Kelley, C. H.** (in preparation). Vowel space and performed identity in male Sevillian speech [Revising for submission to *Spanish in Context*]

Research Projects in Progress

- Sociophonetic Perception of Sexual Identity: Evidence From Native and Non-Native Spanish Speakers**
- IRB approved Bilingual (Spanish/English) perception experiment using matched guise methodology
 - Data collection phase: Fall 2025/Spring 2026

Planned Research

Kelley, C. H. Machine learning applications in regional dialectology: Computational methods for analyzing sexual identity markers across Spanish-speaking regions.

PRESENTATIONS

Guest Lectures

Fall 2020. *Phonetics and Phonology Workshop*. Invited Guest Lecture: SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language course, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Conference Presentations

- Kelley, C. H.** (2024). Phonetic dimensions of gay-sounding speech in Spanish: Syllable-final /s/ variation and persona performance. Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 2024: University of Georgia, Athens, GA.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Analyzing the phonetic performance of male sexuality in Sevillian Spanish through remote data collection. New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWAV) 51: Queens College, Flushing, NY.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Analyzing the performance of male sexuality in Spanish through remote data collection and digital corpus analysis. Congreso Internacional de Lingüística Digital (CILiDi) 2: Universidad de Alicante, Alicante, Spain.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Syllable-final /s/ and the sociolinguistic construction of personae in Spanish speakers. OSU Congress on Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics Symposium (OSUCHiLL) 27: The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH. (Virtual).

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Using sociolinguistic personae to analyze phonetic variation among gay and non-gay Spanish speakers. University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC): The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2022). A pilot study investigating sociophonetic variation among LGBTQ+ speakers in Peninsular Spanish. University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC): The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2021). Sounding queer in Spain: A sociophonetic analysis of production and perception. Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27: California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA. (Virtual).

Kelley, C. H. (2020). Sounding gay and straight in Granada, Spain: Sociophonetic evidence from production and perception. Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27: California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA. (Postponed due to COVID-19).

Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2020). Very? Much!: A corpus analysis of alternation between 'muy' and 'mucho' in Spanish. 10th International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics: Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA. (Canceled due to COVID-19).

Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2017). 'To be' or 'To not be': Attitudes and behaviors toward the split infinitive in English. 8th International Contrastive Linguistics Conference: National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Athens, Greece.

Kelley, C. H. (2016). The Madre Maria de San José (1656-1719) Project. Digitorium: University of Alabama Digital Humanities Conference: The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 3: University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

Poster Presentations

Kelley, C. H. (2025). Prosodic identity performance in Spanish: A mixed-effects analysis of gay and straight vocal personae. Hispanic Linguistics Symposium (HLS) 2025: University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ.

Kelley, C. H. (2022). Performing sexual orientation in Spanish: A pilot study investigating persona and syllable-final /s/ realization. 10th Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics (WSS10): University of Georgia, Athens, GA. (Virtual).

Kelley, C. H. (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. Quantitative Methods in Linguistics course research showcase: The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

GRANTS, HONORS, & AWARDS

Research support award \$675, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2024
Conference funding award \$500, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2023
Research support award \$450, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2023
Conference funding award \$800, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2023
Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research (not funded) \$5,000, American Philosophical Society	2023
Research support award \$600, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2022
Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research (not funded) \$5,000, American Philosophical Society	2022
Research support award \$300, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2021
Conference funding award \$600, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2020
Conference funding award \$762, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2020
Travel Grant \$350, UA Capstone International	2017
Conference funding award \$800, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2017
Graduate Teaching Assistantship UA Modern Languages and Classics	2015 – 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

At Emory University

SPAN 101: Introductory Spanish I

Visiting Assistant Professor

2024 – present

SPAN 102: Introductory Spanish II

Visiting Assistant Professor

SPAN 201: Intermediate Spanish I

Visiting Assistant Professor

SPAN 212: Introduction to Hispanic Texts and Contexts

Visiting Assistant Professor

At The University of Alabama

SP 101: Introductory Spanish I

Graduate Instructor of Record

2015 – 2024

SP 101: Introductory Spanish I (Online)

Graduate Instructor of Record

SP 102: Introductory Spanish II

Graduate Instructor of Record

SP 102: Introductory Spanish II (Online)

Graduate Instructor of Record

SP 103: Intensive Review Spanish

Graduate Instructor of Record

SP 201: Intermediate Spanish I

Graduate Instructor of Record

SP 202: Intermediate Spanish II

Graduate Instructor of Record

SP 353: Spanish Conversation

Graduate Instructor of Record

SP 356: Advanced Grammar and Composition

Graduate Instructor of Record

SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language

Mentored Teaching Assistant to Dr. Bryan Koronkiewicz

At University of Montevallo

SPN 101: Introductory Spanish I

2021 – 2022

Adjunct Instructor

SPN 102: Introductory Spanish II

Adjunct Instructor

SPN 201: Intermediate Spanish I

Adjunct Instructor

EDUCATIONAL TECHNOLOGY EXPERIENCE

- **Online Course Development:** Designed and delivered fully online Spanish courses using video lectures, interactive assessments, and discussion forums to support diverse learning styles and enhance student engagement.
- **Learning Management Systems:** Integrated educational platforms (VHL Central, LingroLearning) into curriculum design, utilizing analytics to monitor student progress and provide personalized feedback for improved learning outcomes.
- **Student Success Support:** Implemented technology-driven assessment and intervention strategies to identify at-risk students early, ensuring equitable access to learning resources and academic support.
- **Faculty Collaboration:** Provided training and technical support to colleagues on effective EdTech integration, fostering collaborative approaches to technology-enhanced language instruction.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Service and Outreach

Linguistic Society of America Committee on LGBTQ+ [Z] Issues in Linguistics (COZIL)

2023 – present

Member

University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)

2021 – 2022

Committee Member

Graduate Student Representative

2021 – 2022

Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA

LengUA Lab Graduate Student Co-director

2020 – 2021

UA (Linguistics research group)

University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)

2020 – 2021

IT Committee member

Spanish 102 Coordinator

2020 – 2022

Spanish Basic Language Program, Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA (43 sections)

University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)

2018 – 2019

Registration Chair

Vice President, La Última Letra UA	2018 – 2019
University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC) Program Committee member	2017 – 2018
LengUA Lab Member	2016 – 2024
Online Teaching Certification UA	2016 – 2024
Secretary, La Última Letra UA	2016 – 2017
Vice President/Program Chair, University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC) UA	2017 – 2018
Convención de la Federación de los Círculos de Español de Alabama Event Judge	2015 – 2020

Development

Dissertation Summer Writing Challenge, The University of Alabama. Summer 2022.

David Bauer Grant Writing Workshop, The University of Alabama. Fall 2021.

Writing for Academic Publication, Advanced Seminar (CSE 690), The University of Alabama. Spring 2019.

Spanish Language Immersion Program, Middlebury Language Schools, Middlebury, VT. Summer 2014.

Study Abroad in Jaén, Spain, University of Alabama at Birmingham and Universidad de Jaén. Summer 2011.

Peer Review

Abstract reviewer, University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)

Professional Memberships

Member, Linguistics Society of America (LSA)

Member, Acoustical Society of America (ASA)

Member, Alabama World Languages Association (AWLA)

Member, Sigma Delta Pi (Omicron Mu Chapter), National Collegiate Hispanic Honor Society

Languages

English (native)

Spanish (near-native proficiency)

French (intermediate proficiency)

Italian (intermediate proficiency)

Additional Skills & Interests

Programming languages: R, Python, HTML/CSS, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Bash/Unix, PRAAT

Operating systems: macOS Monterey, Windows 10

Software: Microsoft Office 365, Adobe Creative Suite, Qualtrics, RStudio, SPSS, PRAAT, Audacity, Montreal Forced Aligner, ELAN, Zotero, EndNote

LMS & cloud services: Blackboard, Canvas, Box, Google Drive, OneDrive, iCloud

Mentoring

Jordyn Battistelli

Fall 2019

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 201 course, UA

Katie Cauley

Fall 2020

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

Jim Moore

Spring 2021

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

REFERENCES

Dr. Alejandro Herrero-Olaizola

Chair and Paul & Phyllis Fireman Professor

Department of Spanish and Portuguese

Emory University

alejandros@emory.edu

Dr. Erin O'Rourke

Associate Professor of Spanish Linguistics

Department of Modern Languages and Classics

The University of Alabama

eorourke@ua.edu

Dr. Bryan Koronkiewicz

Associate Professor of Spanish Linguistics

Department of Modern Languages and Classics

The University of Alabama

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